



that has happened in the last two-and-half years. So in that sense, I think non-hung, Third Front or, you can't say, any government will be better. It can't get worse.

**Goyal:** After the Mumbai terrorist attack, in our democracy which was lacking the so-called horizontal democracy, there is an awareness among the citizens about what they can do and how they can get the correct person in political power. At least among the younger people, there is a kind of awakening on this. So it must translate into better politicians being elected, and hopefully it will in this election. I think as long as there is a stable government, because the coalition is large now, it will be better. And in that context, I must say that the Third Front offers the least prospect for a stable coalition. My feeling is whether it is the present coalition without the Left or the NDA the growth prospects are same. The Third Front, willy nilly dependent on the Left, would be the worst outcome.

**Dev:** Broadly, it doesn't make much difference. There are other parties; we have seen the National Front regime in the past, but the point is whether it is stable or unstable.

**Gokarn:** I think there is a crisis management situation, and both experience and stability are important in this.

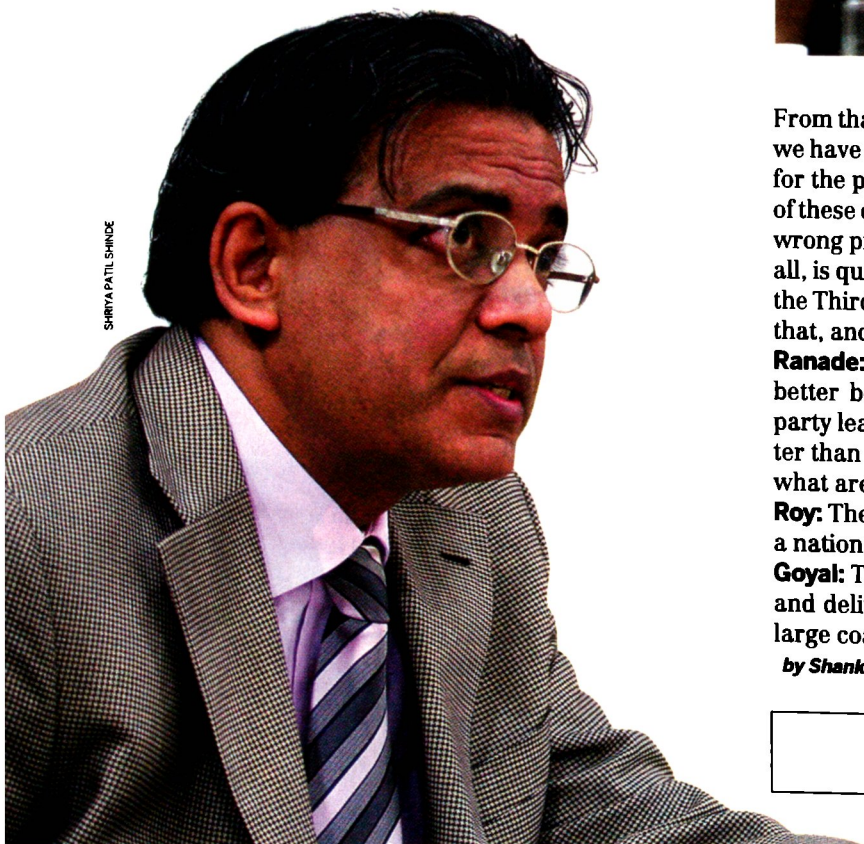
**“ One may criticise the lack of structural reforms but a stimulus is definitely welcome. It will take some time before you start seeing the results, maybe two or three quarters. ”**

SIDDHARTHA ROY, Chief Economist, Tata Group

**“ Banks should bring down interest rates, particularly for retail customers. If passed through quickly, lower rates will spur revival. The pain does not have to be protracted. ”**

ASHIMA GOYAL, Professor, IGIDR

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE



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From that perspective, I think either of the coalitions that we have experienced—UPA or NDA—makes it a little better for the prospects of managing this situation, but the risk of these coalitions not coming in, because they have made wrong pre-poll alliances or have not made an alliance at all, is quite high. So I am not under-estimating the risk of the Third Front coalition coming in. We have to anticipate that, and I think it would be difficult.

**Ranade:** No matter what is coming up, it is going to get better because, of course, we would prefer a national party leading a coalition which would be marginally better than a Third Front. Compared to today, if you ask me what are my views on India, I am going long on this.

**Roy:** The lesser the sectarian interest the better it is. So if a national party leads the coalition, that will be better.

**Goyal:** The electorate must choose somebody who works and delivers, and I think a national party should lead a large coalition.

by Shankkar Aiyar, Nivedita Mukherjee, Mallni Bhupta, Nandini Vaish

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